

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY

 **ATTACK REPORT**

Octalyn: The Stealer Hidden in Plain Sight

Date of Publication

July 17, 2025

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2025222

Summary

First Seen: July 2025

Targeted Countries: Worldwide

Targeted Platform: Windows

Malware: Octalyn Stealer

Attack: The Octalyn Forensic Toolkit, though disguised as an educational tool, is actually a stealthy credential stealer that preys on unsuspecting users. Shared openly on GitHub, it lures in low-skilled actors with a simple builder that creates custom data-stealing payloads using just a Telegram bot token and chat ID. Once deployed, the malware silently steals sensitive information like browser cookies, saved passwords, Discord tokens, crypto wallets, VPN configs, and more organizing everything neatly into folders before zipping it up and sending it back to the attacker via Telegram. What makes Octalyn especially dangerous is how easy it is to use and how convincingly it hides behind a "forensic research" narrative, turning a lightweight GitHub tool into a powerful vehicle for data theft and system compromise.

Attack Regions



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Attack Details

#1

Octalyn Forensic Toolkit presents itself as a research-oriented digital forensics tool, but under the surface, it harbors serious potential for misuse. Built with a modular architecture, it features a C++ based payload and a Delphi-built interface designed to simplify payload creation. Octalyn doubles as a powerful credential stealer capable of extracting sensitive information such as browser credentials, Discord tokens, VPN configurations, gaming account data, and cryptocurrency wallets.

#2

The tool's builder allows attackers to craft custom payloads by inserting a Telegram bot token and chat ID. The core stealer stub written in C++ is embedded within the builder itself. Upon execution, the payload uses Windows environment variables to create a working directory named Octalyn in the system's %TEMP% folder. Within this directory, the malware creates several subfolders to organize the stolen data. Additional executables are dropped into the same directory and executed in sequence using Windows API calls.

#3

Once installed, Octalyn gets to work collecting credentials. It targets Chrome's cookie storage, decrypting the contents using Chrome's local encryption keys. The same routine applies to other Chromium-based browsers like Edge and Opera. This allows the malware to harvest session tokens and sensitive data across multiple platforms. The Telegram bot token and chat ID, stored in plain text within the malware's resources, enable direct communication with the attacker's bot, serving as the command-and-control (C2) channel for exfiltration and further instructions.

#4

In a more advanced phase, Octalyn silently executes a Base64-encoded PowerShell command to reach out to an external server for a secondary payload. This reveals that the attacker still has control over the infrastructure and can potentially deliver new components at will. The malware also ensures persistence by modifying the Windows Registry, adding a new Run key that points to rvn.exe, enabling it to auto-start upon system reboot.

#5

Once the data collection phase is complete, Octalyn compresses all stolen files into a ZIP archive. The archive is structured in a format, featuring neatly organized subfolders. Files such as cookies.txt, passwords.txt, autofill.txt, and history.txt offer a snapshot of a user's online identity and sensitive digital footprint.

#6

Despite its guise as a forensic tool, Octalyn's behavior tells a different story. Its presence on GitHub under the pretext of educational or research use raises concerns about how easily powerful stealer malware can be repurposed and weaponized in real-world attacks.

Recommendations



Don't Trust "Free" Tools from GitHub Blindly: Even if a tool claims to be for education or research, it can contain hidden malware. Always verify the source and scan with trusted antivirus software before running anything downloaded from open repositories.



Be Cautious With Unknown Executables: Avoid running random .exe files especially those disguised as builders or hacking tools. Tools like Octalyn can steal your passwords, cookies, crypto wallets, and more within seconds of execution.



Monitor for Suspicious Telegram Bot Traffic: Octalyn sends stolen data through Telegram bots. Keep an eye on network traffic to Telegram's API, especially from systems that shouldn't be using it. Unexpected connections could indicate compromise.



Review What's Stored in Your Browsers: Stealers often go after saved passwords, cookies, autofill data, and bookmarks. Regularly clear sensitive data from browsers and avoid storing credentials in them use a trusted password manager instead.



Enhance Endpoint Protection: Deploy next-generation antivirus (NGAV) and endpoint detection & response (EDR) solutions to identify and block malware. Leverage behavioral analysis and machine learning-based detection to spot suspicious activity.



Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion
<u>TA0007</u> Discovery	<u>TA0009</u> Collection	<u>TA0010</u> Exfiltration	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control
<u>T1189</u> Drive-by Compromise	<u>T1059</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter	<u>T1059.001</u> PowerShell	<u>T1204</u> User Execution

<u>T1547</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	<u>T1547.001</u> Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	<u>T1140</u> Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information	<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information
<u>T1124</u> System Time Discovery	<u>T1010</u> Application Window Discovery	<u>T1018</u> Remote System Discovery	<u>T1217</u> Browser Information Discovery
<u>T1083</u> File and Directory Discovery	<u>T1082</u> System Information Discovery	<u>T1012</u> Query Registry	<u>T1560</u> Archive Collected Data
<u>T1573</u> Encrypted Channel	<u>T1095</u> Non-Application Layer Protocol	<u>T1071</u> Application Layer Protocol	<u>T1041</u> Exfiltration Over C2 Channel
<u>T1112</u> Modify Registry			

✂ Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	8bd9925f7b7663ca2fcb305870248bd5de0c684342c364c24ef24bffbcdced8b, 3b3a096a9c507529919f92154f682490fa8e135f3460549a917cf23113a7b828, 8bb868a4bd9ed5e540c3d6717b0baa1cd831fc520ee02889bc55e2aac66d9d34, cea94fd48ef98f6e9db120cdb33fa1099846ebcf9e6d6f8de3b53250d2087f0a, 8af7fc21bc9c13d877f598886f363a4c7c1105bcda18e17db74d7e1584a9cae2, abe96669d90f52529b5dad847f43961a4b8b56c3893f6233a404b688c5a6069e, 44778cf0de10af616ef2d8a5cc5048f7cf0faa204563eab590a1a9ea4a168ef7

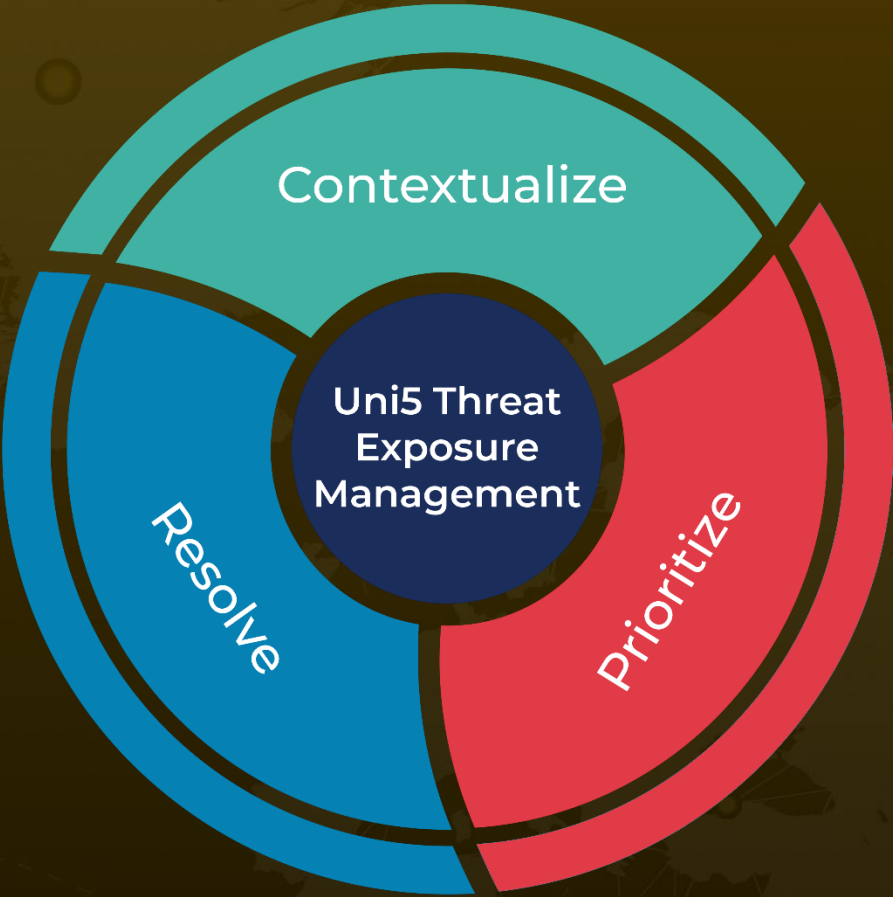
✂ References

<https://www.cyfirma.com/research/octalyn-stealer-unmasked/>

What Next?

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